



(Watch First)  GUINNESS | Welcome Back #LooksLikeGuinness | Review

Guinness: Welcome Back Campaign

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Campaign Overview

The brand I've chosen for the campaign is Guinness, and the product being promoted is Guinness stout. The campaign was created by AMV BBDO, Looks Like Guinness launched in the UK in May 2021, after the year when pubs unfortunately had gone quiet, Guinness had made a simple pint feel like a warm welcome back event, hence the campaign slogan "Welcome Back". The campaign ran across television, online and streaming ads, outdoor prints, and social media. Rather than showing Guinness images directly, the campaign used everyday black and white images that instantly made you think of a Guinness beer. The hashtag #LooksLikeGuinness extended that idea online by encouraging people to notice and share Guinness resembling images in everyday life moments. The campaign's big idea is that Guinness is so visually distinctive that audiences can recognize the brand everywhere just from seeing familiar dark and light looking objects.. One of the most memorable examples is noted as the "white cat sleeping on a black bin", which shows how strong the visual association is to the.



Audience and Objective

The campaign targets legal drinking age adults of course, but more importantly, it appeals to people who see Guinness as part of a social ritual rather than just going out for drinks. Using demographic segmentation, the audience includes adults old enough to buy drinks, likely those who participate in pub and evening social culture. Using psychographic segmentation, the campaign speaks to consumers who value social bonding, tradition, loyalty, and the storytelling surrounding Guinness as a brand. One clue is the campaign's timing, since Guinness launched it as pubs were reopening and people were excited to return to shared social settings with other people again. There is also the campaign's warm and playful tone, which represents Guinness as more than just a drink, it's more of an emotional gathering amongst friends and family. Guinness was targeting people who missed the social ritual of meeting friends for a pint (Campaign US, 2021). A second clue is the media mix and hashtag, the campaign ran across national television, online/streaming services, outdoor prints, and social media, while inviting people to share their own images, which suggests the audience is familiar enough with the brand to show on their own type of social platform. The campaign's main Hierarchy Of Effects objectives are awareness and likeability. It builds strong awareness by linking Guinness to instantly recognizable objects through simple visual similarities, and it builds likability by linking the brand to objects that people see and think about enough to connect it to an entirely different brand, or object that has nothing to do with Guinness.



Message and Creative Strategy

The main message of Looks Like Guinness is that Guinness is such an iconic brand that people can recognize it almost anywhere, especially in small, familiar settings that can make social

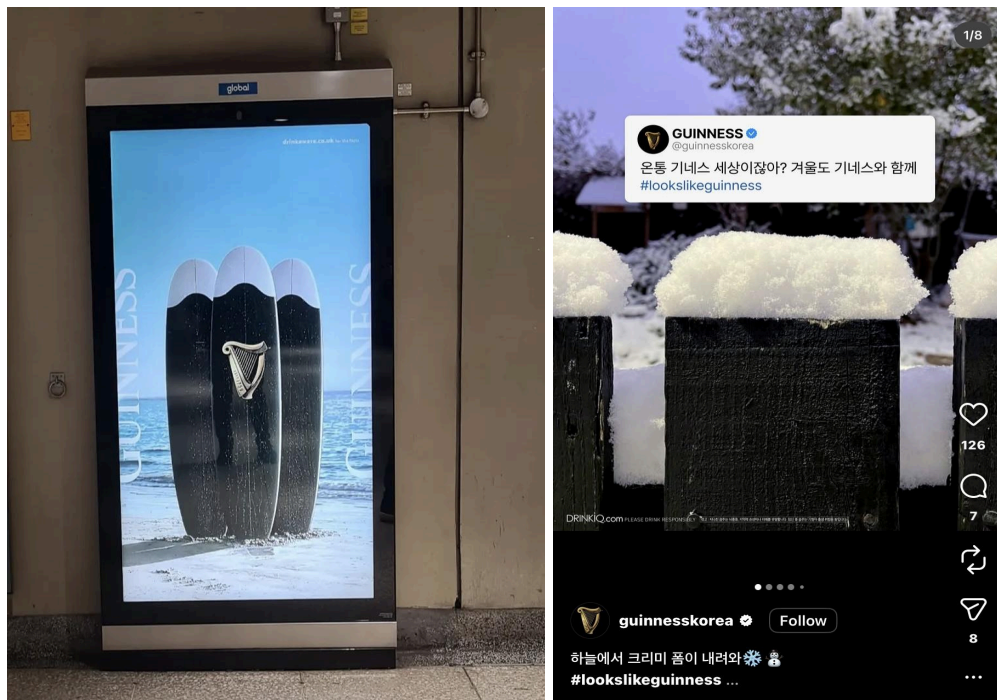
moments with others feel especially meaningful. The campaign mainly uses affective message strategy, specifically resonance/emotional, because it depends on familiarity, memory, and emotional connection rather than basic product knowledge. Its primary appeal is emotion, since it ties Guinness to the comfort of shared experiences, though it also uses light humor through clever visual comparisons with submissions. The executional style is best described as everyday life, since it uses ordinary everyday objects and scenes to make the brand feel naturally present. There is no traditional spokesperson, so the campaign relies heavily on strong familiarity and recognition. It isn't hard to get people to respond to a brand with such strong history and loyalty.

IMC Media Channels and Evaluation



The campaign used television, social media, and outdoor print ads as three of its main IMC channels. Television helped Guinness build broad awareness through video ads played on UK TV spots, while outdoor print placements worked especially well because the campaign's simple black and white visuals were easy to recognize quickly in everyday moments. Social media extended the campaign even further, by using a hashtag it invites consumers to really feel like they were part of the campaign while they got to share their own images (Creative Salon, 2021). One clear example of integration is that every channel used the same core idea: find ordinary objects that resemble a pint of Guinness and connect them back to the brand. This is supported by trade coverage describing the campaign as a multi-channel effort using TV, video, social media, and contextual print to repeat the same visual concept across platforms (Thinkbox, n.d.). I think the campaign was effective because it matched what the audience was about to experience again, returning to social gatherings over a pint. Guinness already had a powerful global identity, which helped the campaign's simple visuals connect with a broad audience, the

company states that Guinness is “brewed in nearly 50 countries around the world and enjoyed in over 150” (Guinness, n.d.). It also ties back to Guinness’s long running slogan, “Good Things Come to Those Who Wait,” making the campaign feel even more meaningful. The campaign was powerful because it connected Guinness to familiarity, reunion, and a return to normalcy after a difficult year.



Reflection



I chose Looks Like Guinness because it’s clever without trying too hard, and I feel like that is what Guinness wanted to accomplish, a welcome home of sorts. I think the campaign was successful because it was simple and allowed people to share their own slightly personal and humorous moments of realization of similarity between random objects and Guinness. I think it

also proved how powerful brand association can be, to connect a brand to an everyday object that has ties to it is a strong quality not every brand will be able to possess. While researching the campaign I connected that IMC works best when the same idea can be shown across different media platforms easily. The campaign was simple, see something that reminds you of a pint of Guinness, capture it, post it. Even while broadcasting through different mediums, the campaign never lost its meaning.

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